StockFlow vs Vyapar

Competitive review, product gaps and implementation roadmap

Decision brief

Prepared for the StockFlow owner | 1 November 2026 | Planning document: no implementation authorized or performed.

StockFlow already has substantial inventory, billing and after-sales functionality. The opportunity is to make these workflows dependable and easier for electrical and bike-accessory shops, while closing selected commercial gaps. Copying every feature of a broad accounting product would spread development effort too thin.

Recommended positioning: fast billing, explainable stock movements, exact variant and serial traceability, and connected warranty/repair handling for specialist retail shops.

The recommended order

- P0: stabilize current workflows, validate financial definitions and shop isolation, and prove backup recovery and hosting availability.
- P1: quotations, business expenses, accountant exports, GST foundations and faster specialist workflows.
- P2: offline operation, complete lot/expiry tracking, settlement reconciliation and external integrations, ordered by customer demand.
- P3: demand forecasting and advanced automation after transaction quality is demonstrably reliable.

How to interpret this report

StockFlow findings are based on the repository review and the workflows discussed in this session. Code or test presence does not establish complete production readiness. “Not found” means no complete workflow was identified in the reviewed code, not proof that every possible implementation path is absent.

Vyapar capabilities are published vendor claims, checked against its official pages. Edition, platform, plan and actual behavior must be verified in a hands-on trial. The supplied screenshots are third-party recommendations; they do not establish reproducible competitor defects.

No verified Vyapar defect is claimed in this report. Competitive opportunities below are hypotheses to test with real shop tasks. No product, SQL, accounting history or shop access settings were changed.

1. Existing StockFlow foundation

Avoid rebuilding features that are already present

Inventory and catalog

- Products, categories, brands, variant SKUs, product images and vehicle-fitment records are implemented. Sequential identifier allocation and product-edit integrity mechanisms help preserve registered identities.
- Physical receiving, purchase receipts, stock intake, adjustments, counts, movement history and location transfers exist. Creating a transfer and confirming physical receipt are separate workflow steps.
- Barcode scanning and label generation exist, including receipt-related labels. Serial/unit identifiers, warranty lookup, warranty claims and repair workflows provide a specialist retail foundation.
- Batch and expiry details are captured on purchase/receipt records. This must not be advertised as complete lot-level inventory control without validating lot balances, depletion, returns and transfers.

Billing, controls and reporting

- Sales invoices, discounts, discount approval controls, split collections, returns and customer/supplier payment workflows exist. Historical generic Card records remain relevant alongside debit/credit-card display choices.
- New Sale intentionally requires collected payment coverage and does not offer Customer Credit / Pay Later. Historical credit balances and collection workflows must remain intact. This is a business-policy tradeoff, not a missing checkbox to restore automatically.
- Roles, staff permissions, store/location access and audit mechanisms exist. Business/profile/tenant boundaries require continuing regression tests; owner access must not silently combine separate shops.
- Reports cover operational stock, sales, collections, outstanding balances and estimated product profit. Product profit is an estimate based on available purchase history, not a full accounting profit calculation.

Recovery and usability

Backup scripts, scheduling support, checksums and a disposable restore-test script already exist. Confirm the actual installed schedule, backup results, offsite storage and restoration procedures before claiming recovery readiness.

Responsive screens, shared pagination/action styles and mobile support provide a foundation. Physical scanners/printers, high display scaling and interrupted workflows still need shop-floor verification.

2. Gaps worth implementing

Prioritize business outcomes rather than feature count

Commercial and financial breadth

- Quotations and estimates — no dedicated complete lifecycle was identified. Add create/revise/share/expiry/status and controlled conversion to invoice. A quotation must not deduct stock unless a separately designed reservation workflow explicitly does so.
- Expenses — no dedicated expense-management workflow was identified. Add categories, supplier/payee, supporting documents, payment references and corrections. Keep operating expenses separate from inventory purchases.
- Accounting — no complete double-entry accounting engine was identified. Begin with accountant-ready exports, documented balances and reconciliation. Journals, trial balance, balance sheet and accounting period controls are a larger, separately scoped project.
- Costing — define valuation and cost-of-goods-sold behavior for purchase price changes, returns and adjustments. Do not label purchase-history estimates as audited profit or net profit.
- GST — tax fields and invoice calculations are a starting point. Complete registration mapping, tax registers, return preparation, reconciliation and statutory integrations were not established in the reviewed code.

Operational depth

- Offline operation — receiving draft storage is present; full offline billing and safe multi-device synchronization were not established. Define invoice-number allocation, stale stock limits, serial conflicts, authorization and recovery before allowing offline finalization.
- Lot/expiry control — add lot balances and receipt-to-sale/return/transfer traceability, expiry alerts and controlled selection where needed. Receipt label “lots” alone do not prove inventory lot accounting.
- Payment settlement — manual confirmation and a reference number are not proof of bank settlement. Add provider/bank reconciliation, unmatched items, reversals, refunds and duplicate-reference controls.
- Replenishment — extend minimum-stock alerts with sales velocity, supplier lead time, pending orders and stockouts before attempting AI forecasting.
- Adoption and hardware — validate catalog/contact/opening-balance migration, duplicate handling, printer output, scanning and day-one staff training. Existing imports/exports do not by themselves prove a safe migration from Vyapar.

Compatibility boundary

Preserve historical invoices, generic Card records, credit collections, returns, refunds, SKU identities and existing balances. New features must not rewrite history or relax separation between the two shops.

3. Competing on a better workflow

Test these opportunities; do not present them as proven Vyapar flaws

Specialist opportunities

- Exact variants: search by SKU, size, color, model and verified vehicle fitment; receive, transfer and sell the correct registered variant without creating duplicates. Measure selection errors and task completion time.
- Serial-to-warranty traceability: connect supplier receipt, manufacturer serial/internal label, invoice, customer, warranty claim and repair history. Measure how quickly staff can resolve a real warranty enquiry.
- Explainable stock: expose opening balance, every receipt/dispatch/return/adjustment, location, user, reason and source document. Measure time to investigate a stock discrepancy.
- Safe interrupted saves: clearly distinguish draft, pending/unconfirmed and completed results. Retry the same request without duplicate invoice creation or stock posting. Test connection loss and double-clicks.
- Clear money reporting: separate invoice revenue from collection dates, refunds and outstanding amounts. A later receipt for an older invoice must not increase current-day sales revenue.
- Accessible counter work: support keyboard/scanner flows and responsive layouts without hiding final actions. Test 1366 x 768, 1280 x 650, 1024 x 768 and 390px width, plus equivalent viewports at Windows 150% scaling.

Same-task competitor benchmark

Use the same sample catalog and transaction sequence in StockFlow and the applicable Vyapar edition: register four variants, receive a partial order with damage, transfer one variant, bill several lines with a discount, collect split payment, return one item and investigate a serial warranty claim.

Also test interrupted submission, two cashiers selling the last available unit, an incorrect duplicate customer, and an old-invoice collection. Record time, clicks, errors, recovery, permission behavior and the final balances.

Only describe a competitor weakness as verified after recording the product version, platform, configuration, reproducible steps and observed outcome. Do not infer inventory or accounting errors from an unattractive screen.

Commercial evidence to gather

Run a supervised pilot with real shop staff. Compare billing time, correction frequency, failed saves, stock discrepancies, support requests and training effort. Choose targets after measuring a baseline; avoid unsupported claims such as “more accurate than Vyapar.”

4. GST for one shop or many

Recommended architecture and placement; not a filing or tax opinion

Where to add it

- Reports > GST & Tax Reports: sales/purchase tax registers, HSN summary, credit/debit notes, GSTR-1 preparation and a GSTR-3B working summary.
- Administration > GST Settings: legal business, registration type, GSTIN, state, shop/location mapping and authorized accountant access.
- Administration > Integrations: authorized provider connection, applicable e-invoice/e-way-bill configuration, retries and integration history.
- Sales > Invoice Details: historical tax particulars and, where applicable, IRN, QR code, submission and cancellation status. A PDF invoice alone is not evidence of IRP registration.

Single-shop and multi-shop behavior

- One shop / one GSTIN: select the registration automatically; keep the period and report selection simple.
- Several branches / same GSTIN: permit branch analysis and an explicitly authorized complete registration-level report. Label restricted branch exports as partial; never imply that partial data is a complete return.
- Different GSTINs: keep tax reports, credentials, submission status and exports separate for each registration. Owner-wide comparisons must not merge statutory returns.
- Separate businesses or tenants: preserve isolation. Any consolidated owner view requires explicit authorization and a deliberate reporting design; never bypass row security for convenience.
- Unregistered or composition businesses: model the actual registration type and applicable document/reporting behavior instead of enabling all regular-taxpayer controls. Confirm the setup with the accountant.

Required foundations

Introduce explicit registration-to-shop mappings and preserve historical issuing/recipient tax details, place of supply and tax components on documents. Electrical/Bike Accessories profiles are operational classifications, not substitutes for legal GST registrations.

Include relevant notes, amendments, returns and cancellations in a reconciled tax register. Keep collections separate from taxable-document reporting. Recorded purchase GST must not automatically be presented as eligible input tax credit.

Deliver registers and accountant exports first, then return preparation/reconciliation, then applicable integrations. Exported, validated, submitted and filed are different states. Direct submission requires supported provider access, authorization and current schema validation.

This work needs database migrations and transaction/reporting changes. GST registration, exemptions, filing frequency and integration applicability must be confirmed for each business against current official requirements; do not hard-code assumptions from shop count.

5. Phased delivery roadmap

Recommended sequence, subject to shop demand and separate approval

P0 — prove the current product

- Reconcile stock, invoices, receipts, collections, returns and refunds using agreed definitions. Investigate differences instead of masking them with dashboard arithmetic.
- Add real HTTP/database contract checks alongside browser tests. Recent page-size validation, hidden discount-reason and layout issues demonstrate the need for integration coverage.
- Exercise concurrent sales, duplicate submissions, last-unit/serial races and uncertain-save recovery. Verify authorization and tenant/profile/location isolation at API and database boundaries.
- Verify scheduled backups, encrypted offsite copies and restoration on a clean environment, including non-database assets and necessary configuration. Define acceptable data loss and recovery time with the owner.
- Verify hosting uptime, restart behavior, logs and alerts. If hosted on a shop laptop, address power/connectivity dependence; a tunnel does not make a sleeping laptop available.

P1 — practical commercial additions

- Quotations with controlled conversion; expenses with supporting records; accountant exports with reconciled totals.
- GST registration mapping, document snapshots and tax registers before statutory submission features.
- Simplify high-frequency variant, receiving, warranty and returns tasks. Validate an import/migration workflow using representative customer data and reconcile opening balances.

P2 — deeper capabilities

- Choose offline synchronization or complete lot/expiry control according to pilot evidence. Both require transaction design, not just extra input fields.
- Add settlement reconciliation and applicable GST integrations. Evaluate physical printing improvements using actual client hardware.
- Add stronger supplier reorder suggestions, inventory aging and actionable discrepancy alerts after agreeing data definitions.

P3 — advanced automation

Demand forecasts and AI-assisted insights should use reliable history and explain their assumptions. Keep write access and automated financial/stock actions outside scope until separately designed and authorized.

Do not attempt full accounting, offline billing, all GST integrations and a visual redesign in one release. Release small vertical workflows with migration, rollback and acceptance evidence.

6. Acceptance and release gates

Evidence required before claiming production readiness

Transaction and accounting checks

- Receiving: direct/ordered receipt, partial receipt, damage, serials, adjustments, cancellation/correction and retries produce the expected stock and document history.
- Sales: all five collected methods, split allocations, cash change, discounts/approvals, invalid payments, concurrent saves and identical-request recovery. New credit remains forbidden; historical credit collection still works.
- After-sales: partial returns, resellable/damaged outcomes, refunds/reversals, warranties and repair parts/payments reconcile without double posting.
- Reports: distinguish sales date, payment date, refund date and the selected balance interpretation. Check changing purchase costs and returned goods before displaying profit.
- Isolation: test identical product/customer names across shops, unauthorized location IDs, exports, search, reports and provider credentials. Owner status alone does not justify access to another tenant.

Usability and operational checks

- Responsive regression: desktop, compact laptop, tablet, 390px mobile, keyboard focus, modal scrolling and close controls, touch targets and final action visibility.
- Search/filter/pagination: validate supported values at the actual endpoint, correct record totals, filter resets, empty results and permissions. Shared components must not couple unrelated pages.
- Hardware: camera and external scanner, representative barcode labels, A4/thermal output and device permission failures. Browser/mobile printing support is not a promise of direct Bluetooth/USB drivers.
- Recovery: restore a real backup into an isolated environment, verify essential records/assets/security, document elapsed time and investigate failed schedules.
- Pilot sign-off: shop owner/accountant validates the real workflow and balances. Preserve a rollback plan and resolve material discrepancies before wider deployment.

Definition of done for each feature

Approved behavior and permissions; documented historical compatibility; relevant database migration and rollback approach; API validation; error/retry handling; meaningful automated checks; representative device tests; and user acceptance. This report is a planning baseline, not approval to deploy.

7. Evidence and limitations

Sources checked during the review | 1 November 2026

Official competitor sources

Vyapar complete feature list: published descriptions of quotations, expenses, payments, GST reports and financial reports. https://vyaparapp.in/blog/vyapar-app-features/

Vyapar business management: vendor claims about billing, accounting, roles, multiwarehouse stock, batch/expiry and offline workflows. https://vyaparapp.in/business-management-software

Vyapar cloud inventory: published claims about offline/cloud synchronization and multilocation inventory. https://vyaparapp.in/free/inventory-management-software/cloud

These sources establish advertised capabilities, not independent performance or correctness. Exact edition/platform availability, price, implementation quality and comparative superiority were not verified.

Official GST references

GST Portal: GSTR-1 preparation guide. https://tutorial.gst.gov.in/userguide/returns/Creation_of_Outward_Supplies_Return_in_GSTR-1.htm

CBIC: published CGST rules including separate registration provisions. This is a dated rules compilation; verify subsequent amendments and the actual registration arrangement before implementation. https://cbic-gst.gov.in/pdf/10112020_CGST-Rules-2017_Part-A_Rules.pdf

Registration, return requirements, input-tax eligibility and e-invoice/e-way-bill applicability need current business-specific review. No turnover threshold or filing deadline is prescribed by this roadmap.

StockFlow code evidence

Catalog, sales, inventory and after-sales: src/StockFlow.Infrastructure/Repositories/{ProductRepository,SalesRepository,PurchaseReceiptRepository,TransferRepository,WarrantyRepository,OperationsRepository,VehicleFitmentStorage}.cs

Current no-new-credit checkout policy: src/StockFlow.Application/Common/SaleRules.cs. Product cost estimate: OperationsRepository.cs. Receiving draft persistence: src/StockFlow.Web/wwwroot/js/receive-goods.js.

Batch/expiry capture: database/migrations/030_receiving_catalog_extensions.sql and purchase/receipt repositories. Receipt-label grouping: BarcodeLotRepository.cs; do not confuse it with a complete inventory lot ledger.

Settings and navigation: CompanySettingsRepository.cs and Pages/Shared/_ReportsNavigation.cshtml. Backup tooling: database/maintenance/Backup-StockFlow.ps1, Install-StockFlowBackupTask.ps1 and Test-StockFlowRestore.ps1.

The review did not execute every production workflow, verify live deployments, inspect every audit path or independently test Vyapar. Older help documents may lag recent changes; implementation and accepted policies take precedence.

Final recommendation

Sell a proven specialist workflow, supported by measurable results. Stabilize and pilot the existing product, add quotations/expenses/GST foundations, and then invest in the advanced capabilities that paying shops actually need. Review this roadmap after the first comparative trial and supervised pilot.